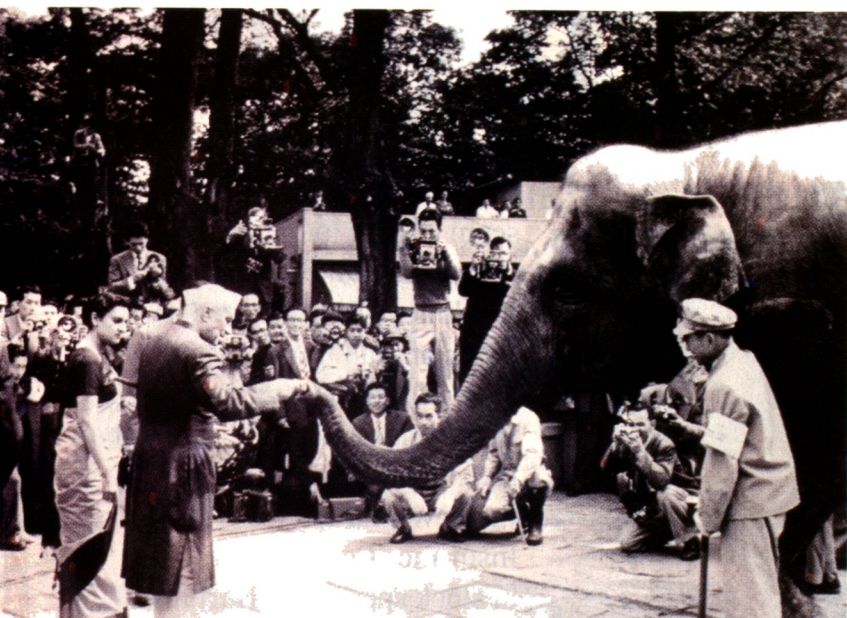




COURTESY NEHRU MEMORIAL AND LIBRARY

An Elephant Named Indira

As his daughter, his official hostess at Teen Murti, Indira Gandhi looks on, Jawaharlal Nehru feeds an elephant which he gifted to Japanese children in 1949, during a visit to Tokyo. It was named Indira. This became a reference point in future ties between the two countries.

- There was a revolution in Iran as the king was **overthrown** and a republican **government** established.
- France sent its troops to **Algeria** to crush a rebel movement. This later came to be called The Battle for Algiers.
- French fashion magnate Christian Dior died and was succeeded by his assistant Yves Saint Laurent.
- USSR launched Sputnik 2 with Laika, a dog, on board.
- Alec Guinness,

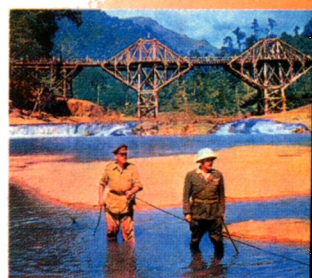
"A GOVERNMENT IS BEST THAT RULES THE LEAST."



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E.M.S. Namboodiripad

India and the world got its first-ever elected Communist leader when CPI's Namboodiripad took over as chief minister of Kerala. The party first commuted the sentences of all death-row prisoners. Fair price shops were opened and labour dispute cases withdrawn. Whether this was Red Terror or a New Dawn, the world was divided. But in the first few months in office, the first Communist government of the country invited the Birlas to set up a factory in the state. The business house was offered bamboo at Re 1 a tonne, though the market price was a thousand times more. During the two years EMS was in charge of Kerala, he initiated educational reforms.



William Holden and Jack Hawkins starred in *Bridge on the River Kwai* (above).

80,544

number of foreign tourists, excluding Pakistanis, who visited India in 1957.

1,216

postal offices across the country handled telegrams in the Devnagri script.

<< DID YOU KNOW

- The Indian polo team won the title at the World Polo Cup in France.
- Archaeologist V.S. Wankar discovered one of the world's largest collections of rock paintings at Bhimbetka caves, that chronicled history right from the Stone Age.

GO, GOA, GO

On August 26, Portuguese troops fired in the direction of the Tarak Pardi post inside India. No casualties were reported and the fire was returned. Portugal filed a complaint before the International Court of Justice protesting that it was being denied the right to pass through Indian territory to get to the Portuguese enclaves, Dadra and Nagar Haveli.